

Hinweise für Schüler

Aufgabenauswahl: Von den vorliegenden 2 Prüfungsblöcken A und B ist **einer** auszuwählen und **vollständig** zu bearbeiten.

Bearbeitungszeit: Die Arbeitszeit beträgt 300 Minuten;
zusätzlich stehen 30 Minuten für die Wahl des Prüfungsblocks zur Verfügung.

Hilfsmittel: Einsprachiges Wörterbuch (Englisch - Englisch)

Sonstiges: Sie sind aufgefordert, die von Ihnen in der Reinschrift verfassten Wörter zu zählen und auf dem Deckblatt zu notieren.
Beachten Sie bitte Folgendes:

- aus der Textvorlage übernommene Zitate werden nicht gezählt
- bei Übernahme von Phrasen aus dem Text, die beispielsweise als Erläuterung einer Aussage dienen sollen, werden maximal drei Wörter gezählt
- Abkürzungen (e.g., USA) gelten als ein Wort
- Kontrahierte Formen (let's, hasn't) gelten als ein Wort
- Ziffern (z. B. 1993) werden nicht gezählt

Der **Umfang** der Arbeit wird **nicht ausdrücklich** festgelegt. Denken Sie daran, Ihre Texte durchzulesen und mögliche Flüchtigkeitsfehler noch zu korrigieren.

Falls die Reinschrift nicht beendet wurde, können Entwürfe ergänzend zur Bewertung nur herangezogen werden, wenn sie zusammenhängend konzipiert sind und die Reinschrift etwa $\frac{3}{4}$ des angestrebten Gesamtumfanges umfasst.

Die Prozentzahl, die hinter den Aufgaben steht, gibt Auskunft über die inhaltliche Gewichtung der einzelnen Aufgaben.

Nach Beendigung Ihrer Arbeit geben Sie die Prüfungsunterlagen bitte vollständig ab.

Aufgabenblock A

The Red Velvet Dress

[...] The afternoon before dinner when a loud knocking came at the front door as she was deep inside a book on her bed, Lena didn't run to answer. Two children she had never seen before stood there awkwardly.

The girl said, "We heard ... well, we wondered..." and stopped.

5 "You wondered what?" Lena asked.

"If we could see the Arab."

"What Arab?"

"The one we heard lived here." [...]

10 Lena's father was in the backyard pitching twigs and dried leaves into a barrel and burning them.

"We don't have one," Lena said, and the girl and boy looked disappointed.

Lena closed the door as quietly as she could without saying good-bye. She went outside and stared at her father in his white undershirt and square blue jeans. He was standing back from the spiralling smoke. He was tipping his head to one side as if he were hypnotized.

15 Oh, she knew where he had come from all right. She knew he came from Jerusalem, Palestine, the holy Land, the land of Jesus, the land of camels and donkeys and olive trees, the land of her grandmother whom she had never seen. She knew about the pilgrims walking from the Old City to Bethlehem. When her father was a boy, he asked his mother if he could walk with the pilgrims, even though his family was Muslim, not Christian. "My mother said yes. She said, Be polite."

20 Lena had never been to her father's old home yet, but she was going, someday, one big day when the horizon opened up. But he wasn't An Arab, the way that girl had said it. He was Daddy. He was Aziz to his friends and their mother. He was a funny tipped laugh and a red-and-white headdress folded up in his bottom dresser drawer. He was worried too, about money, same as everybody was. He didn't want Lena to do things she would regret. [...]

25 She took a deep breath and called out to him. "Daddy, some children came to the door. They wanted to see the Arab and I said we didn't have one. They might be from our school. Are you mad at me?" And her father came and sat beside her and took her hand in his own hand. [...]

30 Lena thought his feelings might be hurt. She said, "I'm sorry," and her daddy laughed so loudly he startled her. "I could have put on my headdress for them! You could have pretended I didn't speak English. Maybe they'll come back and we can make them happy." [...]

A few days later a package arrived from the old country for Lena. Inside it was a red velvet dress, sewn by her grandmother and aunts in the village overseas, stitched with figures of children playing and two angels and birds and interlocking vines, all in different bright

35 colours. At first Lena's mother said it would be a dress-up dress, but Lena didn't dress up that much and it seemed a shame just to let it hang in the closet. So Lena wore it to school. Her mother tied the long velvet ribbons in the back at the waist. She said, "Look at you! You look so elegant I almost don't recognize you!"

40 At school her girlfriends took deep breaths over her dress. They rubbed the velvet between their fingers. "Where did you get this?" they whispered. Lena said, "It is my Arab dress from my Arab relatives far across the sea." Some people said, "We never knew you were an Arab!" and she said, "Oh, yes." But she was also thinking about the German words inside the dreams of her grandparents on her mother's side – they had told her they still had dreams in German

45 even though they hadn't really spoken the language since they were children. [...]

The only problem about the red velvet dress was Lena wanted to wear it every day. It felt so smooth, and comforting. It fit just perfectly around the neck. Not tight, not pulling. All her other dresses and blouses and skirts seemed shabby beside it. Down the street, Norma asked her mother if she could make her a blue velvet dress. She didn't want to copy Lena, but if

50 Lena wouldn't mind...

Something had changed. Now Lena thought about her faraway relatives more. She imagined what her world would look like to them. What would they think of the art wagon at school and the tornado drills when everybody rushed down to the school basement to crouch on the floor and cover their heads with their arms? She wondered if her cousins would be able to

55 climb the rope in PE. Now she thought of their faraway fingers pulling threads through velvet *for her*, thinking of her, and what that meant. It meant they were connected, just as she felt connected to all the people on her block and her friends lining their lunch sacks up beside her own. Now when she pledged allegiance, it was secretly to everywhere.

Adapted from: *The Red Velvet Dress* by Naomi Shihab Nye
in: *Growing up ethnic in America*

Words: 841

Assignments

1. Describe Lena's attitude to her father at the beginning and at the end of the story. 20 %
2. Referring to both form and content, consider how typical an example of a short story the text is. Justify your answer. 20 %
3. Write a letter Lena might send to her relatives in Palestine. You should refer to aspects mentioned in the text. 30 %
4. "National borders are irrelevant." Discuss. 30 %

Aufgabenblock B

Living forever

If we all live to be 150, where will we park?

5 Scientists recently managed to double the lifespan of the common fruit fly. Instead of having only two weeks to hang around on rotting fruit, now they have four. Last month, these same scientists gathered to debate the likelihood that humans would soon be able to do the same thing. (Live longer, that is. Not hang around on rotting fruit. That has always been an option.)

10 The answer was yes. "Future generations may be able to avail themselves of scientifically established techniques to stretch the human life span like a piece of taffy until it reaches 150, even 200 years," reported the New York Times. The piece went on to say that you would not look 200 years old, however that might look (I'm thinking dried fruit). You would live out your extra generations looking and feeling like a 40- or 50-year-old.

15 I cannot speak for fruit flies – though with all that time on their hands (wings? feet?) I expect they'll be mastering English shortly and that sort of thing won't be necessary – but I personally do not want my lifespan stretched like taffy. In my experience, no good comes of stretching taffy. As much taffy as you have is usually more than you want.

20 Likewise life. Who really wants to be around for another 150 years? Imagine it. Movies will cost \$155, and most will star Adam Sandler. Seven-year-olds will be having sex. Health insurance will cost more than a mortgage, forcing people to live in their SUVs, which will by that time be larger than most single-family dwellings anyway. Economy-class airline passengers will be hung vertically on racks similar to those used by dry cleaners. The parking situation alone would be enough to keep me from signing on.

25 I will concede, however, that the people of the 22nd century will need some extra time. Projections based on current figures suggest that it will take an average of 22 hours on hold to reach a customer service at Viacom, several weeks to cross L.A. on Route 495, and the better part of a decade to stand on line at the DMV.

And certainly there would be some pluses to living to 200; my Disney stock might finally do something, and it will be entertaining to watch bell-bottoms come around for the fifth time. But by and large the idea of being alive in the year 2110 is about as appealing as saltwater taffy ...

30 As for stopping the aging process, pish-tush. It can't really be done, even if you manage to stem the advance of physical decrepitude. For aging is more than liver spots and cataracts. Aging is the natural and inevitable process of growing bored with almost everything, and disgusted with everything else. It begins around 35. You start to grow indifferent toward everything you once loved. Your career, your hobbies, Thai food, flirting, getting dressed up.

35 You grow cynical. You grow jaded. Bit by bit, year by year, everything begins to seem stale and pointless. (When, in reality, it is you who is stale and pointless.)

So desperate are you for something different and meaningful that you decide to have children. This passes the time for another 25 years. By then you're pushing 60. You retire. You travel a bit – maybe five years, tops. (By the time you're 70, the list of the countries you actually want

40 to visit has dwindled significantly: Canada, anything Caribbean, Ireland and any country that doesn't put its bathrooms down the hall.)

Imagine having another 100 years. What will there be left to do? Complain. Compete with your daughters for men. Complain. Swat fruit flies (a burgeoning problem, thanks to research gone awry in the late 20th century). The system as it stands has a certain elegance and logic.

45 God makes you get sickly and grotesque, so that by the time you're on your last legs, the thought of leaving it all behind is actually kind of appealing. You die and make room for someone new, someone full of optimism and muscle tone and enthusiasm for today's new music.

50 What would a society do with its old people if they refused to die? How would we handle this ballooning population of healthy but deeply bored and irritable 150-year-old 50-year-olds? To be sure, there will be growth in certain industries (menopause research comes to mind), but how will we manage to employ everyone? Most of the 80-plus crowd will be forced to retire, for what company could stay in business dishing out annual pay increases to its staff for 130 years? How can cutting-edge technology companies bring in new blood if the old blood won't go away?

So they'll have no jobs, no income. What do we do with them? Take all the money that would have been funnelled into funeral homes and adult diapers and people hired to drive those electric carts at airports and use it as a form of welfare? Create subsidized housing out of the thousands of cruise ships dry-docked with the advent of hale and vigorous oldsters? I don't know. I only know I don't want to be there.

Some would accuse me of sour grapes – that because I was born too soon to take advantage of this Brave New World, I can only condemn it. Maybe, maybe not. But I will say this. If the grapes are sour, you have only to leave them out in a sunny spot in your kitchen and they will ripen, and fruit flies will appear, and when they do, you ask them what they think about it.

Slightly abridged from an article by Mary Roach in *The New York Times*, April 9, 1999.

Words: 919

Annotations

<i>Adam Sandler</i> (l. 17)	American actor/comedian
<i>SUVs</i> (l. 18)	sport-utility vehicles
<i>on hold</i> (l. 23)	waiting to speak to someone on the telephone, after your call has been answered
<i>Viacom</i> (l. 24)	telephone company
<i>DMV</i> (l. 25)	Department of Motor Vehicles (at which vehicles are registered)
<i>pish-tush</i> (l. 30)	rubbish; nonsense

Assignments

1. What aspects of today's society does the text examine? 20 %
2. What attitude towards the redoubling of the human lifespan is revealed in the text and how is it conveyed? 20 %
3. "Some people grow old in age and in mind/spirit, while others grow old but remain young in mind/spirit."
Write an article for a lifestyle magazine in which you advise others how to remain young, fit and healthy, both in mind/spirit and body. 30 %
4. Many companies today seem to be proud of the fact that they do not employ anyone over the age of forty.
Give reasons why such companies are boasting about this fact, and consider the effects on society as a whole and on you personally. 30 %